

THINKERS AND BELIEVERS

700 BCE–600 CE

700 BCE		600 BCE		550 BCE		500 BCE	
		c. 600 Ironworking in Nok, Nigeria. Greece continues colonization of Mediterranean with colony of Massalia, founded in southern France. First Greek coins. Paracas culture begins in Peru.		587 Neo-Babylonian Empire under Nebuchadnezzar II destroys Jerusalem's temple and exiles the Israelites.		c. 500 Rice farming reaches Japan from China. Ironworking spreads to Southeast Asia and East Africa. Bronze coins used in China. Zapotecs develop hieroglyphic writing in Central America. Indian caste system in place.	
▲ Hallstatt bird chariot, Celtic bronze, Europe c. 700 Scythians from Central Asia settle in Eastern Europe. Rise of Greek city-states. Early Celtic Hallstatt culture in Europe. Agricultural villages in southeast North America.				c. 550 Cyrus the Great of Persia defeats Medes and founds Persian (Achaemenid) Empire. Rise of Sabaeen and other states around Red Sea. Cast iron produced in China. 539 Babylonian Empire absorbed by Persia.		▲ Cyrus Cylinder, proclaiming Persian sovereignty in Babylon	
		c. 650 First coins minted, Lydia, Asia Minor. Rise of "tyrants" in many Greek cities. Start of ironworking in China. 616 Traditional date for accession of Tarquin, Etruscan king of Rome. ◀ Hesiod		▲ Gate of Babylon c. 563 Possible birth date of Siddhartha Gautama, the Buddha. c. 551 Zoroastrianism official religion of Persia. Birth of Confucius. ◀ Confucius		510 Romans expel Etruscan royal family and establish republic. 505 Cleisthenes establishes democratic government in Athens. ◀ Brick frieze of Darius's palace in Susa	
689 Babylon destroyed by Sennacherib of Assyria. 663 Assyrians sack Thebes in Egypt; their empire reaches its greatest extent. 660 Birth of Jimmu, legendary first emperor of Japan.		612 Assyrian Empire ended with sacking of Nineveh and Nimrud by Medes and Babylonians. 605 Birth of Lao-tzu, founder of Taoism. ▼ Homer's Odyssey				496 Rome defeats Latins at Lake Regillus. 490 Athenian Greeks defeat Persians at Battle of Marathon.	
		Early 500s Much of Middle East controlled by short-lived empire of the Medes; Mesopotamian region dominated by Neo-Babylonian Empire. Paracas textile, Peru ▶		c. 520–460 Indian scholar Panini assembles Sanskrit grammar. c. 515 Darius builds royal residence at Susa, former capital of Elam. Archaic Period Greek figure ▶			
						481 End of "Spring and Autumn" annals, first chronological history of China. 480–479 Xerxes' Persian invasion of Greece is defeated at Salamis, Plataea, and Mycale.	
						480 End of Archaic Period of Greek art; start of Classical Period. 478 Confederacy of Delos, later the Athenian Empire, founded. c. 460 Persian administration adopts parchment.	